

Tester's Guide & Walkthrough

Everything your team needs to log in, explore each role, and try the AI résumé-to-job matching. Built for the University of Cebu — Lapu-Lapu & Mandaue graduate employability platform.

01 Run with Docker

02 Login accounts

03 Alumni

04 Student

05 Industry Partner

06 Alumni Affairs

07 Department Head

08 Admin

09 Sample résumés

10 Known gaps

GETTING SET UP

Run with Docker

GradConnect ships as a self-contained Docker stack, so you don't need to install PHP, Node, or PostgreSQL — only **Docker Desktop**. The whole app (web server, database, and background worker) starts with a single command.

1 • Install Docker Desktop

Download and install [Docker Desktop](#) for your operating system, launch it, and wait until the whale icon is steady (the engine is running). On Windows, keep the **WSL 2** option enabled if prompted, and let it finish its first-time setup before continuing.

2 · Get the project & start it

Open a terminal (PowerShell on Windows) and run these four commands:

```
git clone https://github.com/hernanpanaguiton-glitch/gradconnect.git
cd gradconnect
cp .env.docker.example .env.docker
docker compose up --build
```

Copy

The first build takes a few minutes — it downloads the images and compiles the front-end. It's ready when the log shows `Server running on [http://0.0.0.0:8000]`.

3 · Open the app

Visit `http://localhost:8000` in your browser and sign in with one of the accounts in the next section.

First launch sets everything up for you

Database migrations run and demo data (accounts, jobs, surveys, and the `alumni@` résumé with its AI matches) is seeded automatically on the first boot. The background

queue worker runs as its own container

, so résumé uploads and the *Refresh* buttons process live — no extra commands needed.

Enabling live AI matching (optional)

The `alumni@` account already shows pre-generated AI recommendations you can view immediately. To score *new* résumé uploads or the *Refresh recommendations* / *Refresh matches* buttons, paste the shared Gemini & Groq keys into `.env.docker` (`GEMINI_API_KEY`, `GROQ_API_KEY`), then restart: `docker compose down` then `docker compose up`. Without keys, uploads still save but stay unscored.

Handy commands

```
docker compose up -d          # run in the background
docker compose logs -f app    # watch the app logs
docker compose down           # stop the app (keeps your data)
docker compose down -v        # stop and wipe data for a clean restart
```

[Copy](#)

Stuck on a seeding / "duplicate key" error?

That means a previous run left half-seeded data. Reset with `docker compose down -v` (the `-v` wipes the database), then `docker compose up --build` for a clean start.

SIGN IN

Login accounts

Every demo account uses the password `password`. Pick the role you want to test. (New self-registrations start with no role assigned, so use these instead — an Admin can grant roles afterward.)

ROLE	EMAIL	PASSWORD
● Alumni	alumni@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Student	student@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Industry Partner	partner@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Alumni Affairs	alumni.affairs@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Department Head	depthead.ccs@gradconnect.edu.ph	password
● Admin	admin@gradconnect.edu.ph	password

Hitting a 419 / "Page Expired" on login?

Open the site in a fresh private/incognito window (or clear cookies for the site) and use the exact address above. That resets the session token.

Alumni

A graduate managing their career profile, résumés, job applications, and AI recommendations. This is the best account to see the AI matching in action.

What you can do

- **My Profile** — fill in career details across four tabs: Basic Info, Education, Employment, Skills.
- **My Résumés** — upload a PDF résumé (this is what gets matched to jobs).
- **Job Board** — browse open positions, filter, and apply.
- **Recommendations** — see jobs ranked by AI fit score with explanations and skill gaps.
- **Surveys** — answer open employability & tracer surveys.

What to enter — Profile tabs

TAB / FIELD	EXAMPLE VALUE
Basic Info · Program	BS Information Technology
Headline	Backend Developer
Summary	Laravel developer with 4 years building REST APIs.
Employment status	Employed / Unemployed / Self-employed / Further study
City · Phone · LinkedIn	Cebu City · 0917... · linkedin.com/in/...
Willing to relocate	checkbox
Education	Institution, Degree, Field of study, Start/End <i>year</i> (e.g. 2018–2022), Honors
Employment	Company, Job title, Type (Full-time...), Start/End <i>date</i> , or tick "Currently working here"
Skills	Search and add, e.g. PHP, Laravel, React, SQL

Try the AI matching

- Open **Recommendations** — alumni@ already shows 6 ranked jobs (Backend Developer and Software Engineer score highest for its backend résumé).
- Each card shows a **fit bar**, the model's **explanation**, and green "matched" / amber "gap" skill chips.
- Upload your own résumé under **My Résumés** (see the samples below), then press **Refresh recommendations** to generate a fresh ranking.

Résumés must be PDF

(max 10 MB). Other formats are rejected. New uploads only get scored while the host's queue worker is running.

● **Student** student@gradconnect.edu.ph

Graduating Student

A soon-to-graduate student building a career profile and browsing internships & entry-level roles.

What you can do

- **My Profile** — same profile tabs as Alumni; set an *expected* graduation year.
- **Jobs & Internships** — browse and apply to open positions.
- **Recommendations** — AI job matches once a résumé is uploaded.
- **Surveys** — respond to open surveys.

Tip: build the profile, add a few skills, then upload a résumé to see recommendations populate (queue worker required for new uploads).

● **Industry Partner** partner@gradconnect.edu.ph

Industry Partner

An employer posting vacancies, reviewing applicants, and seeing AI-ranked candidates.

What you can do

- **My Company** — edit the company profile.
- **Job Postings** — create, edit, and close postings.
- **Candidates** — review who applied and update their status.
- **Matches** — see graduates AI-ranked against a posting.

What to enter — new Job Posting

FIELD	EXAMPLE VALUE
Title *	Backend Developer
Description *	Build and maintain REST APIs with Laravel...
Responsibilities / Qualifications	free text
Employment type	Full-time / Part-time / Contract / Internship
Location · Remote	Cebu City · remote toggle
Salary range	45000–70000 (shown as ₱45,000–70,000 / month)
Experience level · Min education	Mid · Bachelor
Status	Open (so it shows on the Job Board)
Application deadline	optional date — the last day to apply
Skills	add skills and tick which are <i>required</i>

After saving, open a posting's **Matches** and press **Refresh matches** to rank applicants by AI fit (queue worker required).

Alumni Affairs Office

Runs employability & tracer surveys and views employment reports.

What you can do

- **Surveys** — create, edit, open/close, and view results.
- **Employability Report** — graduate counts and employment-status breakdown.

What to enter — new Survey

FIELD	EXAMPLE VALUE
Title *	Graduate Employability Survey 2026
Type	Employability / Tracer / Custom
Status	Open (so respondents can answer)
Question prompt	What is your current employment status?
Question type	text, textarea, single choice, multi choice, rating, boolean, number
Options	for choice types: Employed, Unemployed, Self-employed...
Required	toggle per question

Two surveys are already seeded and **open**, so the Alumni/Student accounts can answer them right away.

Department Head

Read-only analytics scoped to their department (College of Computer Studies and its programs).

What you can do

- **Dashboard** — graduates in the department, employment rate, course-related employment.
- **Employability Report** — the same employment breakdown view.

No data entry — this role reviews figures only.

● **Admin** `admin@gradconnect.edu.ph`

Administrator

Manages user accounts and the dynamic roles & permissions system.

What you can do

- **User Management** — search users; edit a user's *status* (active / suspended / pending) and assigned *roles*; delete users.
- **Roles & Permissions** — create custom roles and toggle each permission on a matrix. Core roles are protected from deletion.

Good test: dynamic permissions

Create a role, give it a permission, assign it to a user — that user's available menu and pages change accordingly. Suspend a user and they're blocked at login.

FEED THE MATCHER

Sample résumés to upload

The app accepts **PDF only**. Copy any résumé below into Google Docs or Word, then *Export / Save as PDF* and upload it under an Alumni or Student account's **My Résumés**. Each one is written to match different seeded jobs, so the AI rankings come out clearly different.

- ① **Backend developer** → matches "Backend Developer" / "Software Engineer"

Maria Reyes – Backend Software Developer

Copy

Backend developer with 4 years building web applications and RESTful APIs using PHP and the Laravel framework. Strong in MySQL and PostgreSQL database design and query optimization, Git version control, and Docker-based deployments. Built and maintained REST APIs serving web and mobile clients.

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, University of Cebu.

Skills: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, PostgreSQL, REST API, Git, Docker, JavaScript.

② Frontend developer → matches "Frontend Developer" / "Full Stack Developer"

Noah Cruz – Frontend Developer

Copy

Frontend developer specializing in building responsive, accessible user interfaces with React and TypeScript. Experienced with modern CSS and Tailwind CSS, component-driven design, and integrating REST APIs. Comfortable collaborating in Git-based teams.

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, University of Cebu.

Skills: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, REST API, Git.

③ Data analyst → matches "Data Analyst"

Liza Gomez – Data Analyst

Copy

Data analyst with experience turning raw datasets into dashboards and reports. Strong SQL and Python skills, comfortable with data cleaning, analysis, and visualization to support decision-making.

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, University of Cebu.

Skills: Python, SQL, Data Analysis, Communication, Problem Solving.

What to expect

After uploading and (host-side) the queue processing it, open

Recommendations

: the matching role should sit at the top with a high fit score and a written explanation, while unrelated roles score low.

SET EXPECTATIONS

Known gaps — not bugs

This build covers the foundation plus the AI matching feature. A few menu items are intentional placeholders for future work — please don't log these as defects:

- Sidebar links that do nothing yet: [Career Resources](#) , [Talent Search](#) , [Job Moderation](#) , [System Reports](#) , [Settings](#) , [Alumni Records](#) , [Career Activities](#) , [Graduate Profiles](#) .
- The Employability Report is a basic summary (totals and status breakdown), not a full analytics suite.
- Dashboard numbers reflect current data — AI match counts climb only after résumés are uploaded and scored.
- Self-registration creates an account with no role; an Admin assigns roles afterward. For testing, use the seeded logins above.

Found a real issue? Note the **role**, the **page**, and what you **expected vs. saw** — that's enough to reproduce it quickly.